

HC Services — People Code

Section 7: Definitions, Grades & How to Read This Code

Section 7.0: Document Control

Document Reference: HC-PC-007

Version: 1.2

Effective Date: 1 January 2026

Status: current

Owner: People & Culture Division

Version	Effective from	Superseded on	What changed
1.2	1 January 2026	—	Grade band table at §7.6 restated; Forms Register added at §7.9.

Section 7.1: How to Read the People Code

Where two provisions appear to conflict, they are resolved in this order:

1. **UAE federal law prevails over any provision of this Code.** Where a provision grants less than the statutory minimum, the statutory minimum applies.
2. **An individual contract prevails where it is more generous** than this Code. It may never be less generous.
3. **A specific provision prevails over a general one.** A rule about probation in HC-PC-003 prevails over a general rule in HC-PC-001.
4. **The version in force at the time of the event prevails.** A rule is applied as it stood on the date of the event it governs — the date leave accrued, the date an expense was incurred, the date of absence — not as it stands today. Superseded provisions are retained in each policy's §N.9 appendix for this purpose.
5. Where a conflict remains, People & Culture decides on eligibility and Finance decides on amount.

Section 7.2: Continuous Service

Continuous service runs from the employee's official start date and is not broken by approved annual leave, approved sick leave, maternity or paternity leave, approved study leave, or an internal transfer (HC-PC-003 §3.2.3).

It **is** broken by resignation and re-hire, and by unpaid leave of absence exceeding 30 consecutive days, which does not count toward service.

Continuous service determines annual leave entitlement under HC-PC-001 §1.2.2 and accrual during absence under HC-PC-001 §1.3.2.

Section 7.3: Day Definitions

These three terms are not interchangeable, and the difference changes the answer:

Term	Meaning	Used in
Working day	Monday to Friday, excluding UAE public holidays declared at HC-PC-001 §1.7	Leave notice (HC-PC-001 §1.4.1), probation extension notice (HC-PC-003 §3.6.2), expense approval SLA
Calendar day	Every day including weekends and public holidays	Probation notice (HC-PC-003 §3.4), sick absence during probation (HC-PC-002 §2.2.2), expense submission deadline (HC-PC-005 §5.2.2)
Consecutive day	Unbroken calendar days including weekends	Medical certification (HC-PC-002 §2.3.2)

All times are **Gulf Standard Time (UTC+4)** unless stated otherwise.

Section 7.4: Pay Definitions

Basic salary is the fixed monthly amount stated in the contract of employment, excluding all allowances.

Fixed allowances are allowances paid at the same amount every month regardless of activity: housing allowance, transport allowance, and any role-based allowance stated in the contract.

The following are **not** fixed allowances: overtime, performance bonus, commission, project completion payments, the annual air ticket allowance (HC-PC-003 §3.5.4), and the internet allowance (HC-PC-004 §4.6.2).

Leave pay under HC-PC-001 §1.6.1 is basic salary plus fixed allowances only.

Section 7.5: Rolling 12-Month Period

A **rolling 12-month period** is the 12 months immediately preceding the date of assessment — not the calendar year. An assessment made on 15 August 2026 looks back to 16 August 2025.

Worked example. An employee took 6 sick days in November 2025 and 5 in June 2026. Assessed on 15 August 2026, the rolling period captures both, totalling 11 days — which exceeds the 10-day trigger at HC-PC-002 §2.6.1. Assessed on 15 December 2026, the November 2025 absence has dropped out and only 5 days count.

Section 7.6: Grade Bands

The grade recorded against an employee determines travel entitlement, probation length, and expense authority. Job titles are indicative; **the grade governs**.

Grade	Band	Typical titles	Business class on flights of 5h+	Standard probation	Own expense authority
1–2	Support	Coordinator, Administrator, Supervisor	No	6 months	None
3	Professional	Analyst, Associate Analyst	No	6 months	None
4	Professional	Consultant, Senior Analyst	No	6 months	Up to AED 1,500
5	Senior Professional	Senior Consultant, Team Lead	No	6 months	Up to AED 1,500
6	Management	Manager, Principal Consultant	Yes	6 months	Up to AED 7,500

Grade	Band	Typical titles	Business class on flights of 5h+	Standard probation	Own expense authority
7	Leadership	Director, Senior Manager	Yes	Up to 12 months	Up to AED 7,500
8	Leadership	Senior Director, Vice President	Yes	Up to 12 months	Above AED 7,500
9	Executive	Executive Director, Chief Officer	Yes	Up to 12 months	Above AED 7,500

The business class threshold is set at Grade 6 by HC-PC-005 §5.3.2. The extended probation threshold is set at Grade 7 by HC-PC-003 §3.2.2. **These are different thresholds** — a Grade 6 Manager flies business but serves the standard 6-month probation.

Section 7.7: Role Classification

Roles are classified for remote working by how far the work depends on physical location, not by grade or seniority.

Class A — location independent. The work can be performed anywhere with a secure connection: consulting, analysis, software engineering, design, most People & Culture and Finance work.

Class B — partially location dependent. The work requires regular physical presence with clients or colleagues: client delivery management, recruitment, office-based Finance operations.

Class C — location dependent. The work cannot be performed away from Company or client premises: facilities management, reception, IT hardware support, security, and site supervision.

Classification is recorded against the role, not the person, and is applied at HC-PC-004 §4.2.2.

Section 7.8: Performance Rating Scale

Rating	Label	Meaning
5	Outstanding	Consistently exceeds every requirement of the role
4	Exceeds	Exceeds the requirements of the role in most areas
3	Meets	Meets the requirements of the role
2	Partially meets	Falls short in one or more material areas; improvement plan required
1	Does not meet	Falls materially short; managed under HC-PC-008

A rating of **3 or above** is the threshold for probation confirmation (HC-PC-003 §3.3.2) and for remote work eligibility (HC-PC-004 §4.2.1).

Section 7.9: Forms Register

Form	Name	Owner	Submitted via	Service level
HR-P-01	Mid-probation review	Line manager	Omni	Within 5 working days of the review

Form	Name	Owner	Submitted via	Service level
HR-P-02	Probation extension plan	Line manager	Omni	10 working days before probation ends
HR-P-03	Probation confirmation decision	People & Culture	Omni	Day 165 of probation
HR-R-01	Remote work agreement	Employee	Omni	Approved within 5 working days
HR-S-01	Return to work discussion	Line manager	Omni	First day back
FIN-T-01	Travel pre-approval	Employee	Travel desk	5 working days before travel

Section 7.10: Policies Referenced But Not Yet Published

The following are referenced in this Code but are **not yet published**. Where a question falls within one of them, no answer can be given from this Code and the employee should contact People & Culture directly.

Reference	Title	Status
HC-PC-010	Gratuity & End of Service Benefits	In drafting — target Q1 2027
HC-PC-011	Relocation & Mobility Policy	In drafting — target Q4 2026

For queries about this policy, contact People & Culture at people@hcservices.ae or raise a query via the HCS Concierge.